

Rice Blast

Recognize the problem

Rice blast is a fungal disease. The fungus attacks the leaf, collar, node and neck of the rice plant. Eye-like spots appear on the leaves, which are spindle-shaped with brown borders and grey centres. Under favourable conditions, the spots enlarge and dry the major parts of the leaf, reducing the strength, vigour and yield of the plant.

Background

The disease is spread more quickly in moist conditions such as during long periods of rain showers and absence of the sun. These conditions are more favourable to infection than heavy rainfalls of short duration. Heavy application of nitrogen is also favourable for heavy blast infection. The disease can remain in crop stubble/debris after harvest and can also be seed-borne.

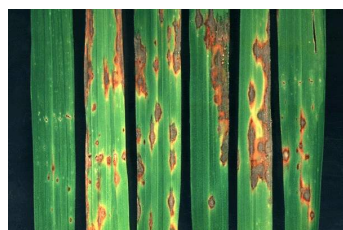
Management

- Do not use infected seed for rice sowing
- Avoid late sowing of the rice crop
- After harvesting, burn the debris from the infected crop
- Apply nitrogen and phosphorus fertilizer in adequate quantities
- During severe attack, apply recommended fungicides when the disease appears, i.e. Chlorothalonil (e.g. Deconil 75w) @250 gm, Tetrachlorophthalide (e.g. Rabicide 30wp) 250gm in 100 litre of water
- Use goggles, gloves, wear shoes and do not spray the field against wind
- Avoid drinking eating and smoking during spray

Rice Blast on Nodes. (Photo by Donald Groth, Louisiana State University AgCenter (CC BY))



Rice Blast on leaves. (Photo by Chin Khoon Min)



When using a pesticide, always wear protective clothing and follow the instructions on the product label, such as dosage, timing of application, and pre-harvest interval.

Scientific name(s) > **Magnaporthe grisea**

The recommendations in this factsheet are relevant to: Pakistan

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